As I have already mentioned, with the end of the Cold War in 1991, the old EEI became irrelevant; it was replaced by the new EEI, which focused on the threats of nonconventional weapons and global terrorism. It was not long before the (mainly, but not exclusively) Western intelligence services realized that the new EEI required them to make significant changes in their definition of objectives and methods of conduct, especially with regard to cooperation with other services at a much higher level than in the past. It was clear that without cooperation the various agencies often got in each other's way, with damage sometimes being caused as a result. And most importantly, the potential of the intelligence and operations that could have been produced via cooperation was far from being fully exploited.

In the Mossad, this situation was felt intensely. As mentioned, the new EEI required the Mossad to expand its operational range far beyond the Middle East. I noticed that the Mossad was working increasingly on the same goals and objectives as the CIA, and sometimes as other intelligence services in Europe. My conclusion was that the era of cooperation in its old format had also ended. In addition to cooperation on intelligence, research, and evaluation, there was now a need for operational cooperation. Our people had begun to recognize and even encounter CIA operatives, among others, in the same theaters of action and near the same targets we had been working on around the world. The optimal solution was, of course, to agree on a division of labor and then share the results. However, when we proposed this to the CIA, our suggestion was not warmly received. There were several reasons for this, in my view. One was the American obsession with concealing sources and capabilities. Another was the fact that the CIA collaborated with countless intelligence services around the world, and a division of labor with the Mossad alone might raise some eyebrows. Finally, the CIA had clearly defined levels of cooperation with friendly agencies—it was quite possible that our proposal for a division of labor would have involved elevating the level of our relationship.

However, since the preemption component in both nonconventional weapons and global terrorism continued to develop beyond the component of intelligence gathering, the heads of Western intelligence agencies, including the CIA director, understood that operational cooperation could not be avoided. Such cooperation began to grow, on a bilateral and even a multilateral basis, when agency heads accepted that on these issues no intelligence agency could triumph by itself and that interservice cooperation